# NIGHT OPERATIONS

## BASIC RISK ASSESSMENT GUIDE FOR ALL PERSONNEL

This guide covers the main hazards you will face during night operations. **Read it. Know it. Follow it.**
If you are unsure about anything, **ask your Team Leader before starting work.**

| # | HAZARD | WHAT CAN HAPPEN | WHAT YOU DO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Reduced visibility** | You cannot see obstacles, trip hazards, open hatches, or other personnel. Collisions, falls, and injuries increase significantly at night. | ✓ **Allow extra time for your eyes to adjust to darkness**<br>✓ **Move slowly and deliberately — never rush on deck at night**<br>✓ **Use designated walkways and lit routes only**<br>✓ **Carry a torch as backup even when deck lighting is on** |
| 2 | **Fatigue and tiredness** | You are tired, slow to react, and make mistakes. Missed hazards, poor decisions, dropped equipment, and serious injuries. | ✓ **Tell your Team Leader if you are too tired to work safely**<br>✓ **Take scheduled rest breaks — do not skip them**<br>✓ **Stay hydrated and eat before night shifts**<br>✓ **Watch your teammates — if someone looks exhausted, speak up** |
| 3 | **Trips and falls on deck** | You trip over mooring lines, deck fittings, hatch coamings, or unseen obstacles. Broken bones, head injuries, or falling overboard. | ✓ **Know the deck layout before darkness falls**<br>✓ **Use handrails at all times when moving around the vessel**<br>✓ **Keep walkways clear of loose kit and lines**<br>✓ **Wear non-slip footwear with ankle support** |
| 4 | **Man overboard at night** | Someone falls into the sea in darkness. Recovery is much harder at night — hypothermia, drowning, and delayed rescue are all more likely. | ✓ **Wear your lifejacket with light and whistle at ALL times on deck at night**<br>✓ **Know the MOB alarm and recovery procedure before your shift**<br>✓ **Never work alone on deck at night — always use the buddy system**<br>✓ **Stay away from unguarded edges** |
| 5 | **Weapons handling in darkness** | Negligent discharge, dropped weapons, wrong target identification. Serious injury or death to yourself or teammates. | ✓ **Follow all NSPs — no exceptions, day or night**<br>✓ **Use weapon-mounted or helmet-mounted lights for any weapons handling**<br>✓ **Positive target identification before any action**<br>✓ **Secure all weapons when not in use — no loose firearms on deck** |
| 6 | **Vessel transfer at night** | You cannot see the ladder, the gap between vessels, or the sea state properly. Falls between vessels, missed footholds, drowning. | ✓ **Transfer only with proper lighting on both vessels**<br>✓ **Wait for Master confirmation — do not rush**<br>✓ **Full PPE including lifejacket with light, helmet, non-slip gloves**<br>✓ **One person moves at a time — no crowding the transfer point** |
| 7 | **Communication breakdown** | You cannot see hand signals in darkness. Wrong timing, missed instructions, people in the wrong place. Accidents and near-misses. | ✓ **Radio check before every night evolution**<br>✓ **Use radio comms, not hand signals, at night**<br>✓ **Confirm all instructions by repeating them back**<br>✓ **Carry a backup radio or whistle** |
| 8 | **Lighting failure** | Deck lights fail or are inadequate. Total darkness on deck — immediate danger from every other hazard on this list. | ✓ **Always carry a personal torch as backup**<br>✓ **Report any failed or flickering lights immediately**<br>✓ **STOP WORK if lighting fails — do not continue in darkness**<br>✓ **Know where emergency lighting switches are** |

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|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | **Heat exposure (night shifts)** | Persian Gulf night temperatures can still exceed 35°C. Heat exhaustion, dehydration, cramps, heatstroke — all worse when fatigued. | ✓ **Drink water regularly — do not wait until you are thirsty**<br>✓ **Take cooling breaks in shaded or air-conditioned areas**<br>✓ **Watch for signs in yourself and others: dizziness, confusion, no sweating**<br>✓ **Report any heat illness symptoms immediately** |
| 10 | **Emergency response at night** | Fire, flooding, medical emergency, or security incident in darkness. Evacuation routes harder to find, muster points harder to reach, casualty harder to locate. | ✓ **Know your emergency muster point and route BEFORE your night shift**<br>✓ **Keep your torch and lifejacket within arm's reach at all times**<br>✓ **Follow the emergency lighting and signage — do not freelance**<br>✓ **Account for all team members at muster — headcount is critical at night** |

## STOP WORK – YOU HAVE THE RIGHT

If you believe the task is not safe, you must stop and speak up.

**No one will be punished for refusing an unsafe operation.** Tell your Team Leader. If they do not listen, contact the Group Compliance Director directly.

**Full risk assessment:** SM/HSE/RA/010 – Night Operations v1.0
**Related SOPs:** Night Operations SOP (when issued) | SM/HSE/PRO/001 – Hazard ID & Risk Assessment
**Questions?** Contact the Group Compliance Director or QHSE Manager

**YOUR WATCH. OUR STANDARD.**
Assess. Report. Deliver.